



ENERGY WATCH

POLESTAR INSIGHTS

REPORTING PERIOD: 5 SEPTEMBER 2026 - 11 SEPTEMBER 2026

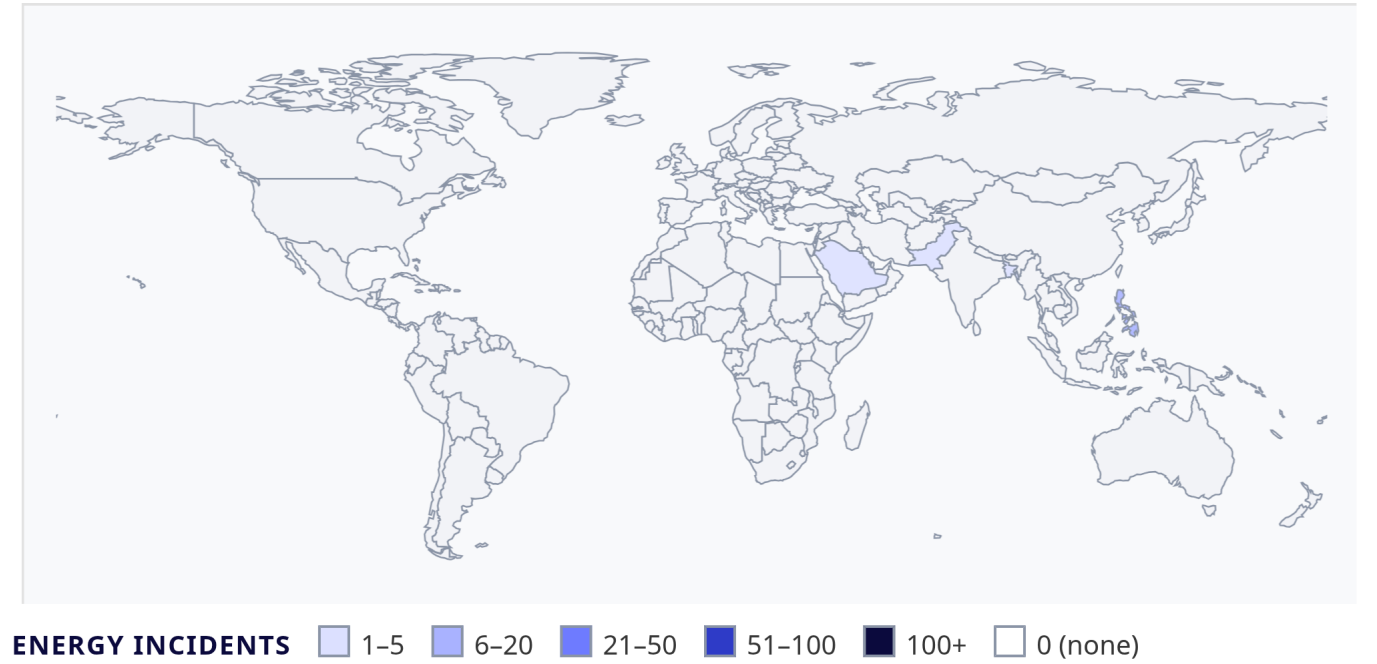
FAST FACTS

REPORTING PERIOD 5 Sep - 11 Sep 2026	MOST AFFECTED COUNTRY Philippines 18 records	POWER SUPPLY Longer brownouts Cebu faces longer brownouts as Visayas power shortage worsens
INFRASTRUCTURE OUTAGE Substation fire Substation fire cuts power to parts of Dhaka for hours	ELECTRICITY COSTS Higher electricity costs Brownouts now, higher Visayas power bills in September	BUSINESS IMPACT Market vendors affected Colon Night Market vendors grapple with rotational brownouts

BLUF

This window was defined by sustained power stress rather than isolated faults. The clearest pressure points were prolonged load shedding in Simkot, recurring brownouts and red-alert conditions in the Visayas grid, and a substation fire that cut power to parts of Dhaka for hours. Energy disruption risk is Moderate overall, with the most immediate continuity pressure where outages are already recurring or where a single infrastructure failure has shown the ability to interrupt supply quickly.

ENERGY SITUATION MAP



MARKET PRICES

ELECTRICITY (US CITY AVG)

US city average retail electricity

0.197 USD/kWh

-0.5% MoM



As of Jul 2026 · BLS / FRED (APU000072610)

NATURAL GAS (EUROPE)

EU import natural gas

17.93 USD/MMBtu

+18.8% MoM



As of Jul 2026 · IMF / FRED (PNGASEUUSDM)

NATURAL GAS (HENRY HUB)

Henry Hub natural gas spot

2.810 USD/MMBtu

-2.4% 7d



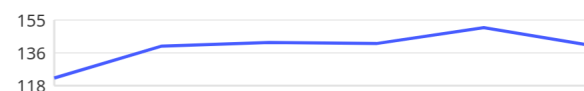
As of 09 Sep 2026 · EIA / FRED (DHHNGSP)

THERMAL COAL (AUSTRALIA)

Australian thermal coal

140.4 USD/mt

-6.6% MoM



As of Jul 2026 · IMF / FRED (PCOALAUUSDM)

ENERGY SITUATION

The current pattern is one of constrained power systems facing both sudden local faults and longer-running supply pressure, with limited headroom and rising cost stress rather than a single uniform outage trend.

SIMKOT

Simkot was reported to be facing 22 hours of daily load shedding.

DHAKA

Dhaka saw an hours-long outage after a substation fire cut power to parts of the city. Separate reporting from Dhaka indicated that some load shedding would need to be accepted, pointing to continued strain beyond the fire itself.

BANGLADESH

Reporting also pointed to load-shedding concerns in Bangladesh more broadly.

PAKISTAN

Pakistan saw attention on rising electricity tariffs and bills. Reporting from the window framed Pakistan as affected by electricity tariff pressure rather than a specific reported outage event.

VISAYAS

Consumers in the Visayas were reported to have endured recurring rotational brownouts in August. Tight supply and power plant outages pushed wholesale electricity prices in the region to their highest level yet. The Visayas grid also slipped back into red alert amid continuing and worsening outages, and the power shortage prompted a push to fast-track three energy projects.

HORMUZ

Vessels were reported hit near Hormuz.

SAUDI PIPELINE

Satellite images fuelled claims of an attack on a Saudi pipeline. This was assessed in the reporting as a High-severity development for fuel-to-power risk because it raises pressure on energy flows, although no direct domestic power outage was reported in Saudi Arabia in this window.

WHAT MATTERS

The main continuity issue is reduced predictability. Long daily load shedding and city outages can interrupt shifts, refrigeration, cash handling, lifts, lighting and mobile charging, while wider supply strain raises the chance that disruption lasts beyond the initial fault.

Tight supply and red-alert conditions also matter for cost and backup planning. Higher wholesale prices and tariff pressure can feed through into diesel use, generator run-time and electricity bills, while fuel-flow concerns add a dependency risk even where no immediate blackout is reported. Attention is best focused on locations already showing weak reserve margins, recurring brownouts or explicit acceptance of load shedding.

IMPLICATIONS FOR BUSINESS

- - Check backup generation readiness and fuel stocks at sites in Dhaka, the Visayas and Simkot.
- - Update business continuity plans for multi-hour outages and repeated daily load shedding.
- - Review shift timing and critical process scheduling where grid supply is already unstable.
- - Confirm that access control, lifts, cooling and communications can operate during power loss.
- - Prepare for higher electricity and generator running costs in the Visayas and Pakistan.
- - Issue local staff updates in affected cities when outages alter travel timing or site access.

WATCH NEXT

- - Further red-alert declarations or rotating brownout notices in the Visayas grid
- - Additional reports of power plant outages or tight supply in the Visayas
- - Any extension of load shedding measures in Dhaka beyond the current reporting
- - Restoration updates and follow-on faults linked to the Dhaka substation fire
- - Changes in daily outage duration in Simkot
- - Further tariff or billing changes in Pakistan
- - Confirmed impacts on Saudi energy infrastructure after the reports near Hormuz

POLESTAR VIEW

Risk level: Moderate. The most likely disruption remains repeated electricity interruption in the Visayas, Dhaka and Simkot, with the sharpest continuity pressure where outages are already prolonged or where grid conditions have returned to red alert. Prioritise backup power resilience, short-notice communications on access and timing, and cost controls where tariff and wholesale price pressure is rising.

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